

OAS-018 — Attention Architecture

Status: Foundational

Authority: Architectural

Depends on:

- OAS-000 through OAS-017
 - OCS-000 through OCS-032
-

Purpose

This specification defines the architectural organization of Attention.

Attention is the constitutional mechanism through which architectural resources become focused.

Attention is not notification.

Attention is not priority.

Attention is the dynamic allocation of awareness toward constitutional understanding.

Architecture SHALL organize Attention without allowing it to redefine constitutional importance.

1. Architectural Objective

The objective of Attention Architecture is to ensure that limited attention strengthens understanding rather than distorting it.

Architecture SHALL optimize for:

Meaningful discovery.

Constructive inquiry.

Perspective diversity.

Learning.

Reflection.

Attention SHALL remain a guide.

Not an authority.

2. Definition

Architectural Attention is the temporary concentration of constitutional awareness upon one or more constitutional constructs.

Attention MAY focus on:

Questions.

Places.

Voices.

Evidence.

Conversations.

Libraries.

Patterns.

Attention SHALL remain transient.

Meaning SHALL remain persistent.

3. Attention Independence

Attention SHALL remain independent of:

Popularity.

Commercial incentives.

Algorithmic optimization.

Participant status.

Implementation technology.

Attention SHALL be explainable.

4. Attention and Meaning

Attention SHALL NOT redefine constitutional meaning.

Frequently attended constructs SHALL not automatically become more constitutionally important.

Neglected constructs SHALL not lose constitutional significance.

Meaning SHALL remain independent of attention.

5. Attention Flow

Architecture SHALL preserve the movement of Attention.

Attention MAY shift through:

Questions.

Evidence.

Relationships.

Conversations.

Discoveries.

Reflection.

The movement of Attention SHALL itself become architectural information.

6. Attention Diversity

Architecture SHALL avoid permanent concentration of Attention.

Alternative perspectives SHALL remain discoverable.

Architecture SHALL encourage exploration beyond established paths.

7. Attention Memory

Architectural Attention MAY preserve its historical patterns.

Attention history SHALL support:

Reflection.

Learning.

Architectural improvement.

Bias detection.

Attention history SHALL remain explainable.

8. Attention Federation

Federated Places MAY exchange signals of Attention.

Signals SHALL remain advisory.

Local Places SHALL retain sovereignty over their own architectural Attention.

9. Attention Verification

Verification SHALL demonstrate:

Explainable allocation.

Historical reconstruction.

Perspective diversity.

Constitutional neutrality.

Equivalent constitutional behavior.

10. Attention Pattern

Architecture SHALL organize Attention around constitutional relationships rather than engagement metrics.

Engagement measures activity.

Attention cultivates understanding.

Architecture SHALL preserve this distinction.

11. Attention Architecture Test

Attention Architecture satisfies this specification when an independent architect can reconstruct:

Why attention moved.

What influenced it.

Which constitutional relationships guided it.

How neglected knowledge remained discoverable.

How attention contributed to understanding.

Without relying on implementation-specific ranking systems.

Conformance

An implementation conforms to this specification when Attention remains explainable, constitutionally neutral, historically reconstructable, and independent of popularity or implementation-specific optimization.

Architectural Principle

Attention is the rarest resource in every civilization.

Architecture therefore bears the responsibility of guiding attention without capturing it.

The purpose of Attention Architecture is not to decide what deserves attention,

but to ensure that every participant remains capable of discovering what truly matters before it is already obvious.

End of Specification OAS-018